



WSC-LLM: Efficient LLM Service and Architecture Co-exploration for Wafer-scale Chips

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Abstract

The deployment of large language models (LLMs) imposes significant demands on computing, memory, and communication resources. Wafer-scale technology enables the high-density integration of multiple single-die chips with high-speed Die-to-Die (D2D) interconnections, presenting a promising solution to meet these demands arising from LLMs. However, given the limited wafer area, a trade-off needs to be made among computing, storage, and communication resources. Maximizing the benefits and minimizing the drawbacks of wafer-scale technology is crucial for enhancing the performance of LLM service systems, which poses challenges to both architecture and scheduling. Unfortunately, existing methods cannot effectively address these challenges.

To bridge the gap, we propose WSC-LLM, an architecture and scheduling co-exploration framework. We first define a highly configurable general hardware template designed to explore optimal architectural parameters for wafer-scale chips. Based on it, we

capitalize on the high D2D bandwidth and fine-grained operation advantages inherent to wafer-scale chips to investigate optimal disaggregated scheduling strategies, effectively addressing the highly dynamic demands of LLM workloads. Compared to the state-of-the-art (SOTA) LLM service systems, WSC-LLM can achieve an average overall performance improvement of 3.12× across various LLM models and datasets. Moreover, we leverage WSC-LLM to reveal intriguing insights about wafer-scale architecture design and the execution of LLM workloads.

CCS Concepts

• **Computer systems organization** → **Architectures**; • **Software and its engineering** → **Compilers**; • **Computing methodologies** → *Machine learning*.

Keywords

scheduling, architecture, wafer-scale chips, large language model

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ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-1261-6/25/06

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3695053.3731101>

ACM Reference Format:

Zheng Xu, Dehao Kong, Jiaxin Liu, Jinxi Li, Jingxiang Hou, Xu Dai, Chao Li, Shaojun Wei, Yang Hu, and Shouyi Yin. 2025. WSC-LLM: Efficient LLM Service and Architecture Co-exploration for Wafer-scale Chips. In *Proceedings of the 52nd Annual International Symposium on Computer Architecture (ISCA '25)*, June 21–25, 2025, Tokyo, Japan. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 17 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3695053.3731101>

1 Introduction

In recent years, large language models (LLMs) based on the transformer architecture have emerged as a driving force behind advancements in artificial intelligence (AI). It has demonstrated remarkable capabilities and exceptional performance across various domains, including natural language understanding and content generation [8, 9, 13, 18, 76, 77]. To achieve superior performance, the number of parameters in LLMs has increased dramatically, resulting in a substantial rise in computational resource demands. In addition to the large number of model parameters, the LLM inference process also generates a significant amount of key-value (KV) cache, further exacerbating memory requirements.

Affected by the end of Moore's Law [55] and the constraints imposed by limited photomask size [5], it is difficult for a single hardware device, such as an individual GPU or NPU, to achieve sufficient transistor scale and memory capacity to support LLMs tasks. As a result, distributed computing architectures is essential for efficient LLM inference. However, deploying LLMs across multiple devices introduces additional challenges in communication. Disaggregate LLM inference necessitates large-scale transmission of model weights and KV cache across devices, imposing demands on high-bandwidth interconnects. Currently, interconnect communication bandwidth has become the primary bottleneck limiting the performance of these LLM serving systems [10, 45, 85].

Wafer-scale chip design method [33], using advanced packaging technologies such as CoWoS [29] to expand the chip area, provides a promising solution to meet the computation, memory and communication resource demands of LLM inference and enable high-density 3D integration. Vertical integration of modules such as power supply, cooling, and I/O interfaces achieves exceptional integration density, which in turn maximizes compute density and interconnect bandwidth. Currently, wafer-scale GPU [61], UCLA & UIUC's work [60], Cerebras WSE2 [50], and Tesla's Dojo [73] have been introduced. One widely used, cost-effective, and high-yield wafer-scale approach involves integrating NPU and DRAM chiplets together [60, 61, 73]. Compared with the most advanced GPUs [7] and high-speed rack-scale fabrics (i.e., NVLinks [6]), these wafer-scale chip works can provide around 50× the number of transistors and 6× the inter-chip bandwidth.

However, this technology introduces new challenges for architectural design and LLM inference scheduling for wafer-scale chips, which are outlined below:

For *architecture design*, the key challenge is determining the optimal DRAM capacity per die. The weights of LLMs can reach hundreds of gigabytes [2–4, 9, 13, 18, 66, 75, 96], and KV cache storage demands are similarly substantial. As illustrated in Fig. 1(a), a higher DRAM capacity facilitates the simultaneous execution of a greater number of requests, thereby enhancing the overall quality of LLM services. However, larger DRAM capacity implies that DRAM chiplets will occupy more wafer area and demand additional Die-to-Die (D2D) interconnect interfaces, which will reduce the available compute and communication resources. All the above adverse effects are collectively referred to as *DRAM Costs*. Consequently, a trade-off arises between integrating larger DRAM capacities within a single die to support extensive weights and KV cache storage demands and smaller DRAM capacities to reduce *DRAM Costs*. Balancing this trade-off remains an unsolved challenge.

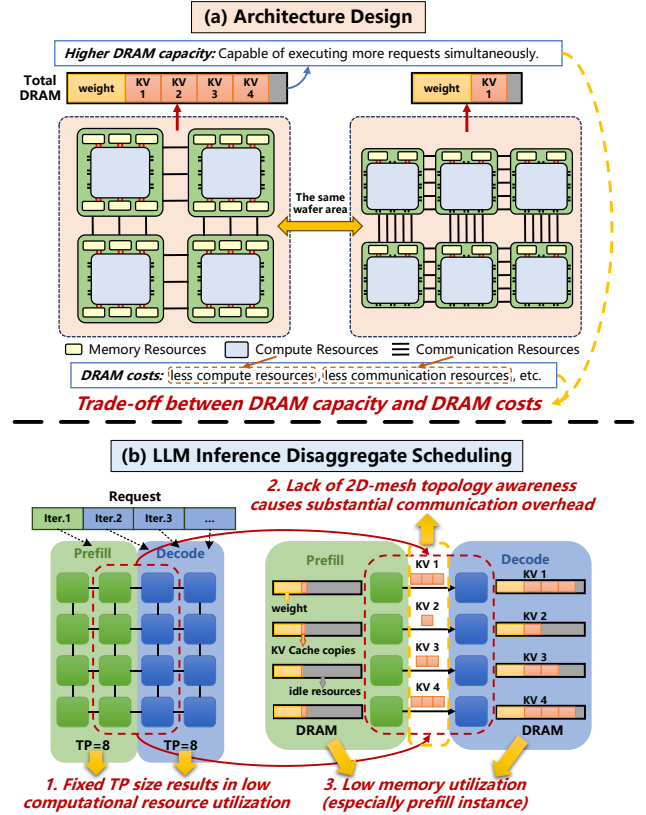


Figure 1: The challenges when LLMs meet wafer-scale chip.

For LLM inference scheduling, the main challenge lies in managing the highly dynamic nature of LLM workloads, which stems from the division of LLM request processing into two distinct phases: prefill and decoding. Resource demands of the same request in different phases vary significantly [28, 30, 62, 71, 84, 85, 100]. Consequently, using identical devices and execution strategies for both phases often leads to inefficiency. A potential solution is *disaggregated scheduling*, which partitions devices into multiple groups, each deploying an LLM instance for a specific phase and applying a phase-specific execution strategy tailored to its characteristics [30, 31, 62, 84, 100]. However, as illustrated in Fig. 1(b), it faces several limitations. First, optimizing tensor parallelism (TP) strategy and group configuration is crucial for maximizing computational performance during both the prefill and decoding phases. Nonetheless, most existing works select fixed configurations based on engineering experience, lacking precise problem definition and exhaustive exploration. Second, these solutions [30, 31, 62, 100] require KV cache transfers during the phase transition, and the lack of design for wafer-scale 2D-mesh topology may incur substantial communication overhead that cannot be masked effectively by pipeline execution. Third, due to isolation among groups, the memory of different device groups cannot be collectively utilized to store the KV cache for a single request. And most KV cache storage is concentrated in the decoding device group, leading to inefficient memory utilization.

The above analysis reveals that employing wafer-scale chips to efficiently serve LLMs introduces intricate trade-offs and challenges. This not only poses challenges for architectural design but

also necessitates efficient parallel execution strategies and scheduling solutions to fully leverage the computation, memory, and communication resources of wafer-scale chips. To address these challenges, we have made the following contributions:

- Based on a highly configurable and universal hardware template, we propose WSC-LLM, an efficient scheduling and architecture co-exploration framework for wafer-scale chips. To the best of our knowledge, this is **the first** work to achieve it.
- We specifically develop strategies tailored to the characteristics of the wafer-scale architecture to optimize tensor parallelism, resource allocation and placement, and memory management. These algorithms aim to explore the most efficient disaggregated scheduling strategies while efficiently managing KV cache storage, thereby maximizing the utilization of hardware resources on wafer-scale chips.
- We utilize WSC-LLM to reveal several intriguing insights about wafer-scale architecture design and the execution of LLM workloads as follows. (1) With the support of WSC-LLM, wafer-scale chips equipped with moderate DRAM capacity per die can effectively balance computation, storage, and communication resources, thereby delivering the best LLM service quality. (2) Supported by our advanced memory management strategies, achieving efficient LLM service requires not only high DRAM bandwidth but also sufficient communication bandwidth. A balance between memory and communication resources is essential for optimal performance. (3) Our investigation into the impact of various optimization strategies on LLM inference performance reveals that the memory optimization strategies in WSC-LLM contribute more significantly to enhancing LLM service quality compared to computation optimization strategies.
- Compared to the SOTA LLM service systems, WSC-LLM can achieve an average overall performance improvement of 3.12 $\times$ across various LLM models and datasets.

2 Background

2.1 LLM Inference

Most popular large language models (LLMs) [2, 8, 9, 76, 77] employ a decoder-only Transformer architecture [78]. The model consists of a stack of transformer layers, each containing an attention layer and a feed-forward network (FFN) layer. Attention layers make tokens in a request interact with other tokens, while FFN layers process requests in a token-wise manner.

As shown in Fig. 2, LLM inference process comprises two distinct phases: prefill and decoding. During the prefill phase, the LLM model processes all input tokens in parallel upon receiving a user request, generating the first token while caching the computed key-value (KV) pairs across all transformer layers. This cached data, formally termed KV cache [63], eliminates redundant computation of historical token matrices during subsequent decoding phase. The prefill process exhibits characteristics similar to the training forward pass and is computation-intensive. In the decoding phase, it uses the last generated token and the KV cache as inputs to generate tokens iteratively until reaching the termination token. The KV cache exhibits linear growth proportional to both the model

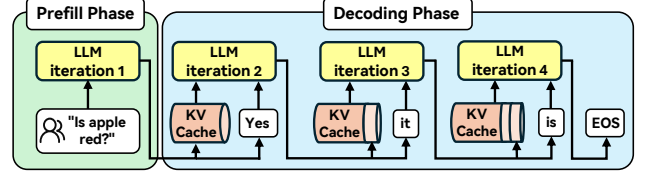


Figure 2: Prefill and decoding phase in the LLM inference.

parameters and the input sequence length. For GPT-175B [13], a single request with an input sequence length of 1,024 tokens generates approximately 4.5 GB of KV cache. Consequently, the decoding phase involves massive KV cache accesses, imposing significant demands on both memory capacity and bandwidth. Furthermore, transferring KV cache data between different hardware devices imposes substantial communication bandwidth demands.

2.2 LLM Serving System

With the increasing size of models, model parallelism has become essential for both training and inference. Model parallelism allows a model to be distributed across multiple devices. The two primary types of model parallelism used in inference are tensor parallelism (TP) [48, 54, 64, 70, 87, 88, 92, 93, 97] and pipeline parallelism (PP) [12, 21, 31, 36, 49, 56]. TP divides tensors along specific dimensions, distributing the partitioned computations across multiple devices to allow concurrent execution of different parts of an operator. In contrast, PP distributes different operators in the computational graph across devices, representing an orthogonal approach. Typically, TP is more effective than PP for devices within the same large high-bandwidth domain [62]. Given the wafer-scale chip's capability to deliver a large high-bandwidth domain across the entire wafer, our optimization efforts focus primarily on TP.

In real-time online LLM service systems [10, 45, 85, 91], continuous batching is a commonly used technique that processes the prefill and decoding phases of multiple requests in each iteration. However, since the prefill and decoding phases are constrained by computation and memory bandwidth, respectively, continuous batching results in prefill-decoding interference. To address this issue, disaggregated inference [31, 62, 72, 100] separates prefill and decoding phases onto different devices. While this approach can enhance service quality and achieve simultaneous optimization of the prefill and decoding phases, challenges such as imbalanced resource allocation, additional communication overhead, and sub-optimal memory utilization persist.

2.3 Wafer-scale Chip

Benefiting from advances in packaging technologies like Through-Silicon Vias (TSV), Chip on Wafer on Substrate (CoWoS), Redistribution Layer (RDL) [26, 29, 32, 34, 46, 47, 95], wafer-scale chip is a feasible and promising architectural solution to further scaling up chip sizes. There are two mainstream technical routes. The first is monolithic integration, where all compute dies and interconnects are directly integrated on wafer-scale chip [50, 60, 68]. The other method is chiplet-based integration, in which compute dies are fabricated separately and then integrated into the wafer-scale chip along with interconnects [60, 61, 69, 81]. This approach enables flexibility, configurability, and high scalability through integration

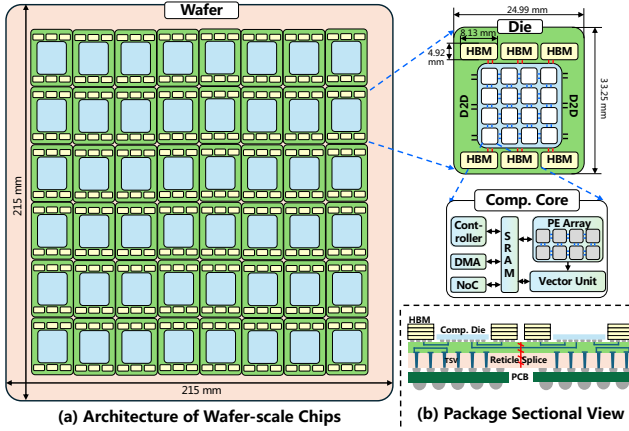


Figure 3: Architecture of wafer-scale chips.

with diverse devices on the wafer. Moreover, compared to the first approach, chiplet-based wafer-scale chips made through mature technology and production enhance yield and reduce redundancy. Therefore, we adopt the chiplet-based integration.

(1) Overall Architecture: As depicted in Fig. 3(a), the hardware template architecture consists of three hierarchical levels: wafer, die, and computing core. The architecture employs a mesh topology for the 215 mm×215 mm wafer, utilizing Die-to-Die (D2D) interconnect interfaces to facilitate communication between adjacent dies. This configuration supports various communication types, such as Die-to-Die, Die-to-DRAM, and DRAM-to-Die. Although alternative topologies, such as torus and fully-connected designs, are feasible, the constraints on interconnect distances and the need to maintain signal integrity often reduce bandwidth and efficiency. Therefore, the mesh topology remains the optimal choice.

(2) Die Architecture: Each die, measuring 24.99 mm×33.25 mm, integrates both computational and storage functionalities. This integration marks a significant shift from conventional chiplet designs [15, 69, 74], which typically separate these functions. As shown in Fig. 3(a), each die comprises multiple computing cores, on-die memory (DRAM chiplets), NoC interconnections, and D2D interconnect interfaces. The NoC interconnections also follow a mesh topology, facilitating high-speed communication between cores. The placement of D2D interfaces around the die periphery contributes to a scalable architecture.

(3) Computing Core Architecture: As illustrated in Fig. 3(a), each computing core is responsible for executing computational tasks. The controller manages core operations using pre-defined instructions and coordinates data transfers across external cores and DRAM. DMA and NoC systems handle communication between cores, ensuring efficient data flow within the framework. Each core has globally shared SRAM, while the PE array and vector unit performs General Matrix Multiplication (GEMM)/General Matrix-Vector Multiplication (GEMV) and vector/scalar operations, respectively.

(4) Configurable Parameters: Our hardware template offers extensive configurability and scalability suited to wafer-scale chips, including the number of dies in both horizontal and vertical directions, DRAM and SRAM bandwidth and capacity, as well as NoC and D2D bandwidth. Additionally, the parameters of the

compute die are also configurable, encompassing the number of cores in the horizontal direction, the number of cores in the vertical direction, and the number of MACs in the PE array. The design of the PE array and its dataflows are derived from existing works [14, 17, 19, 27, 41, 43, 74, 80, 90].

(5) Package Sectional View: As illustrated in Fig. 3(b), the wafer-scale chip employs an interposer layer to enable high-speed communication both between compute dies and between compute dies and DRAM. This design avoids low-speed communication by bypassing the multiple dielectric transitions typically encountered from the chip, through the interposer and substrate, to the PCB. Consequently, this configuration improves communication speed (higher D2D bandwidth), reduces transmission distances, and enhances signal integrity.

3 Motivation

3.1 Trade-off Introduced by DRAM capacity

LLM workloads impose substantial demands on computation, storage, and communication resources. Although wafer-scale technology can effectively scale monolithic devices, it remains constrained by the limits of the wafer size. For example, the maximum usable area of a 12-inch wafer is approximately 46225 mm^2 ($215 \text{ mm} \times 215 \text{ mm}$) [33]. Consequently, wafer-scale chips necessitate trade-offs among various hardware resources. However, existing research has not examined this. In this section, we discuss the benefits and drawbacks of increasing DRAM capacity on wafer-scale chips.

Fig. 4(a) and (b) illustrate large and small DRAM capacities configurations within a single die, respectively. In Fig. 4(a), DRAM chiplets are positioned on both sides of the compute die, while in Fig. 4(b), they are arranged on only one side. Increasing the number of DRAM chiplets allows for higher DRAM bandwidth by utilizing more compute-die interconnect interfaces.

As shown in Fig. 4, expanding DRAM capacity on wafer-scale chips offers two primary advantages. First, increased DRAM capacity allows for storing more weights and KV caches, theoretically enabling the simultaneous processing of a higher number of LLM user requests. Second, it can enhance DRAM bandwidth, which is particularly crucial for decoding, as this phase is memory-bound. Given that the decoding phase often constitutes the majority of the runtime across most workloads, higher DRAM bandwidth can significantly improve the quality of service for LLMs by reducing memory-related bottlenecks.

However, Fig. 4 also highlights its associated disadvantages. First, the number of interconnect interfaces is fixed for the same computing die. An increase in the number of DRAM chiplets results in a higher proportion of computing-die interfaces being occupied by memory access bandwidth, reducing the number of interfaces available for Die-to-Die (D2D) communication. Consequently, the D2D communication bandwidth decreases, thereby limiting inter-die data transfer efficiency. Second, additional DRAM chiplets occupy more wafer area, leading to a reduction in the total number of dies per wafer and consequently lowering the overall computational capacity of the system.

These trade-offs underscore the critical balance between DRAM bandwidth and capacity, D2D bandwidth, and computational resources for achieving optimal LLM performance.

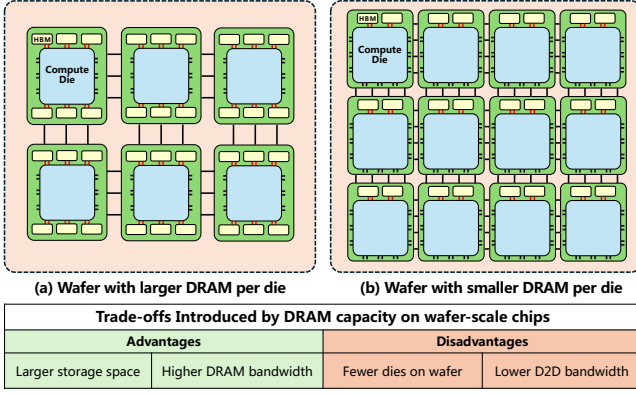


Figure 4: Trade-offs Introduced by DRAM capacity on wafer-scale chips.

3.2 Problems with existing LLM serving systems

Although existing LLM serving systems [30, 31, 62, 100] recognize the differences between the prefill and decoding phases and map them to separate machines, they still face the following issues.

First, these systems overlook the exploration of optimal TP granularity and resource allocation and placement for both prefill and decoding instances. Current approaches typically set the TP size to a fixed value such as 8 GPUs (one node) and rely on engineering experience for instance allocation. Fig. 5(a) shows the average iteration time for the prefill and decoding phase in LLaMA3-70B under the optimal TP strategy across different TP sizes and batch sizes. Detailed TP strategies and compute die configurations are provided in Section 4.5.1 and Section 5.1. The result reveals that increasing TP size accelerates the computation-intensive prefill phase while saving DRAM space. However, in the decoding phase with lighter computational demands, larger TP size may reduce performance due to additional communication overhead. Thus, the optimal TP size may differ between two phases, necessitating distinct execution strategies. Furthermore, the optimal allocation and placement of hardware resources between two phases remains an open problem requiring systematic exploration.

Second, these systems require KV cache transfers from prefill to decoding instances, resulting in substantial inter-node communication overhead. Due to the limited communication bandwidth across GPU clusters, this overhead cannot be effectively overlapped with computation. While wafer-scale chips provide higher bandwidth that holds promise for solving this problem, their 2D-mesh topology differs fundamentally from the all-to-all topology of GPU clusters. Without topology-aware scheduling, communication traffic becomes imbalanced, leading to severe congestion on certain links and making high communication overhead persist.

Third, the memory utilization of these systems is suboptimal. Fig. 5(b) illustrates peak DRAM utilization for prefill and decoding instances when running the LLaMA3-70B model and the conversation dataset on wafer-scale chips, where each die is equipped with 96GB of DRAM. Details of the die configurations and workloads are provided in Section 5.1. DRAM utilization in prefill instances is significantly low due to the KV cache transfer. Furthermore, decoding instances also cannot utilize all DRAM resources because they cannot store the KV cache of the same request across instances.

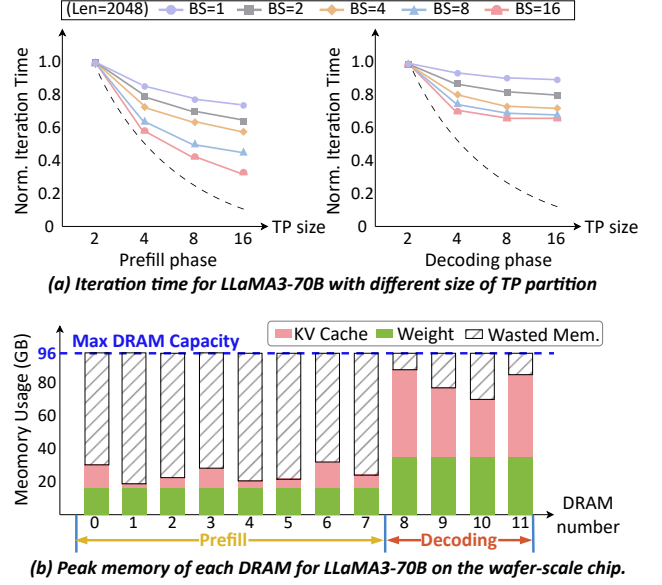


Figure 5: Request performance under different TP sizes in different phases and memory utilization in prefill and decoding instances.

4 WSC-LLM Framework

4.1 WSC-LLM Overview

WSC-LLM is a scheduling and architecture co-exploration framework for wafer-scale chips, marking the first work of its kind. As depicted in the left of Fig. 6, the inputs for WSC-LLM consist of architecture parameter candidates, LLM models, and workload. Within the constraints of wafer area limitations, architecture parameter candidates are derived from arbitrary combinations of configurable parameters (introduced in Section 2.3).

All architectural candidates are exhaustively explored by the Scheduling Engine to achieve optimal LLM service quality on wafer-scale chip with varying architecture parameters. At the core of the Scheduling Engine is the Central Scheduler, which leverages the TP Engine to explore the optimal TP configurations, resource allocation and placement strategies while managing the allocation of user requests within the Execution Engine. The exploration of the optimal TP configuration and resource allocation (Section 4.2.1), as well as the resource placement strategy (Section 4.2.2), are both executed offline. Therefore, they do not introduce any additional system overhead during the online execution of the Central Scheduler. Furthermore, the Memory Scheduler determines the optimal KV cache storage location, ensuring efficient utilization of storage resources and minimizing additional communication overhead.

4.2 Central Scheduler

4.2.1 Optimal Resource Partition Strategy. Motivated by the need to support the dynamic nature of LLM workloads efficiently, we map the prefill and decoding phases to separate hardware resources, creating distinct instances of prefill and decoding phases. However, this approach introduces two new unresolved issues: determining the optimal instance size and TP setup for each phase and selecting

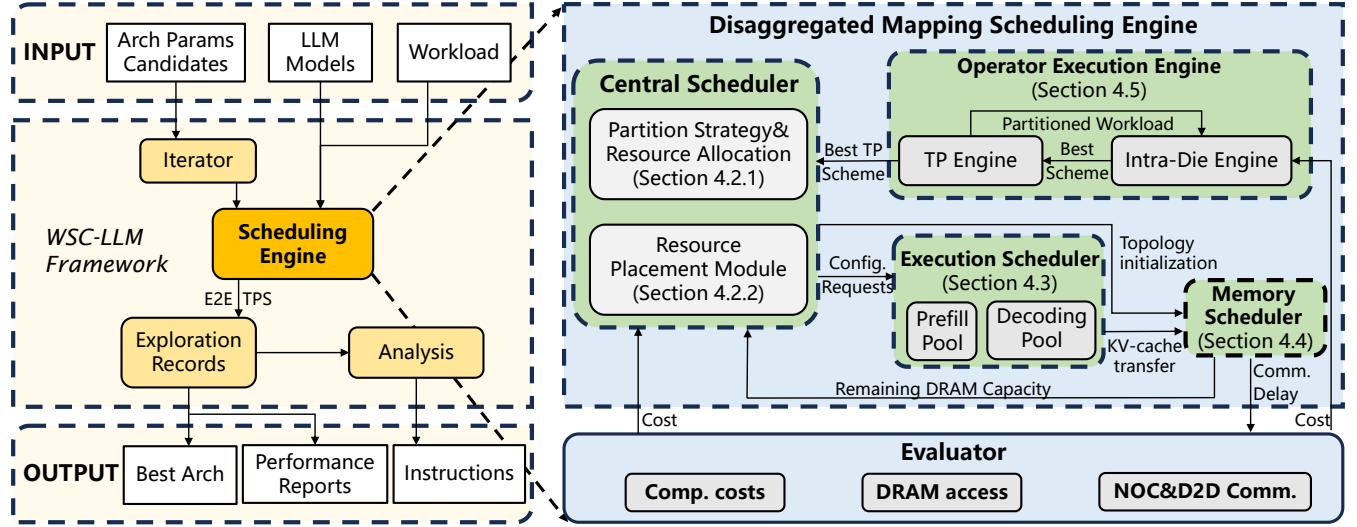


Figure 6: WSC-LLM framework.

the appropriate number of instances for the prefill and decoding phases.

To tackle these challenges, we propose Algorithm 1, which systematically optimizes the resource partitioning for prefill and decoding phases. The algorithm first optimizes the prefill and decoding instance size along with their TP setup independently to achieve phase-level optimal per-die throughput. Subsequently, to achieve globally optimal performance, we employ a replication strategy, which means the instance size for each phase is uniform, and the same TP strategy is applied across the same phase. At last, the number of prefill and decoding instances is determined based on the traffic balance between the prefill phase and the decoding phase.

Given the model M , constraints on the number of dies per instance D , memory capacity of a die c , workload W , TP partition strategy S (Detailed in Section 4.5.1), and the total number of dies N , the algorithm can determine the best partitioning setup (*prefill_setup* and *decoding_setup*) and allocates the appropriate number of instances for each phase (NP and ND). The workload W is obtained by resampling the distribution after fitting the test dataset (introduced in Section 5.1).

The algorithm iterates through all feasible instance sizes, which are constrained by the die limit per instance (line 3) and the total memory capacity (line 4). Additionally, it is important to note that, in order to satisfy the communication requirements imposed by the 2D-mesh topology of wafer-scale chips, the arrangement of dies within each instance must be a rectangular shape, which means that linear or other irregular shapes are not permitted. The algorithm then enumerates all possible TP partition strategies for a fixed instance size (line 5). Subsequently, we determine the goodput for the prefill phase by the prefill workload $W_{prefill}$ (line 7), and similarly, determine it for the decoding phase by the decoding workload $W_{decoding}$ (line 8). Notably, the *test* function operates as a simulator that executes workload on a single instance, without incorporating cross-instance scheduling. While throughput is influenced by both placement and scheduling strategies, the goodput measured here solely reflects the performance within a single

instance. It represents the upper performance bound that can be achieved after optimized global scheduling, helping identify setup with greater potential for scheduling improvements. Once the optimal setup for both phases are identified (lines 9-13), we replicate them to achieve the optimal overall performance by balancing the throughput of each phase. We determine the number of prefill and decoding instances according to the total number of dies N and the proportion of their throughput (lines 18-19).

The complexity of Algorithm 1 is $O(DS)$, where D is the die limit per instance, and S is the number of pre-defined TP partition strategies. The search space remains manageable, with a solving time of only a few minutes, even in the largest instance and LLM model scenario.

4.2.2 Optimal Resource Placement Strategy. In Section 4.2.1, we explored the optimal instance sizes and numbers for the prefill and decoding phases. However, due to the characteristics of the 2D-mesh topology in wafer-scale chips, it is also necessary to determine the optimal placement of each instance.

Since the results of prefill instances (i.e., KV cache) are used by decoding instances, data transfer only occurs from prefill instances to decoding instances. Given this scenario, the objective is to minimize the total distance between each prefill instance and its nearest decoding instance while avoiding overlapping transmission paths. To achieve this, we adopt a strategy that prioritizes central placement for decoding instances: the decoding instances are placed in the central region first, followed by the placement of prefill instances around the perimeter. If placement schemes are not unique, we select the one that minimizes the total communication cost. This selection is formalized as:

$$\text{TransferCost} = \sum_{i=0}^{NP-1} \min_{j=0}^{ND-1} \text{Distance}(P_i, D_j) \quad (1)$$

where NP and ND denote the number of prefill and decoding instances, respectively. P_i and D_j represent the center positions of prefill and decoding instances, where $i \in [0, NP - 1]$ and $j \in$

Algorithm 1: Optimal Resource Partition Algorithm

Input: Model M , dies limit D , memory capacity per die c , workload W , TP split strategy S , total dies N .

Output: $prefill_setup$, $decoding_setup$, number of prefill instances NP , number of decoding instances ND .

```

1  $prefill\_setup \leftarrow \emptyset$ 
2  $decoding\_setup \leftarrow \emptyset$ 
3 for  $ins \in \{1, 2, \dots, D\}$  do
4   if  $\frac{M.weight}{ins} < N \cdot c$  then
5     for  $s \in S$  do
6        $TP \leftarrow (M, ins, s)$ 
7        $prefill\_goodput \leftarrow test(TP, W\_prefill)$ 
8        $decoding\_goodput \leftarrow test(TP, W\_decoding)$ 
9       if  $\frac{prefill\_setup.goodput}{prefill\_setup.TP.ins} < \frac{prefill\_goodput}{ins}$  then
10         $prefill\_setup \leftarrow (TP, prefill\_goodput)$ 
11      end
12      if  $\frac{decoding\_setup.goodput}{decoding\_setup.TP.ins} < \frac{decoding\_goodput}{ins}$  then
13         $decoding\_setup \leftarrow (TP, decoding\_goodput)$ 
14      end
15    end
16  end
17 end
18  $NP \leftarrow \left\lceil \frac{N \times prefill\_setup.goodput}{prefill\_setup.goodput + decoding\_setup.goodput} \right\rceil$ 
19  $ND \leftarrow N - NP$ 
20 return  $prefill\_setup, decoding\_setup, NP, ND$ 

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$[0, ND - 1]$. Distance refers to the shortest path between prefill and decoding instances. In cases where multiple shortest paths exist, all such paths are enumerated. Among these, a non-overlapping path configuration is selected to achieve optimal matching.

It is noteworthy to add a hyperparameter $\alpha \geq 1$ when there is the reuse of communication links. For example, in Fig. 7(a), the Distance(P_1, D_1) = 2 hops, whereas Distance(P_5, D_1) = $(2\alpha + 2)$ hops, because the paths from P_5 to D_1 and P_1 to D_1 share 2 hops. The value of α depends on the number of shared links and the ratio between D2D and DRAM bandwidths. For instance, in the scenario depicted in Fig. 7(a), the number of shared links is 2 (for P_1 and P_5 to D_1). Therefore, if the D2D bandwidth exceeds twice the DRAM bandwidth, then $\alpha = 1$.

Fig. 7(a) and (b) illustrate the placement results of applying the random strategy and our decoding-centered strategy, respectively, on a wafer-scale chip with 48 dies, where NP is 8 and ND is 4. The corresponding TransferCost are $(8\alpha + 16)$ hops and 16 hops, respectively, demonstrating the superiority of our approach.

4.3 Execution Scheduler

4.3.1 Prefill Pool. In the prefill pool, each prefill instance maintains a queue QP_i to manage user requests assigned to it. Each queue employs a first-come-first-serve (FCFS) strategy for scheduling batched requests. To maximize hardware utilization when handling irregular prefill prompt lengths, we adopt the chunked

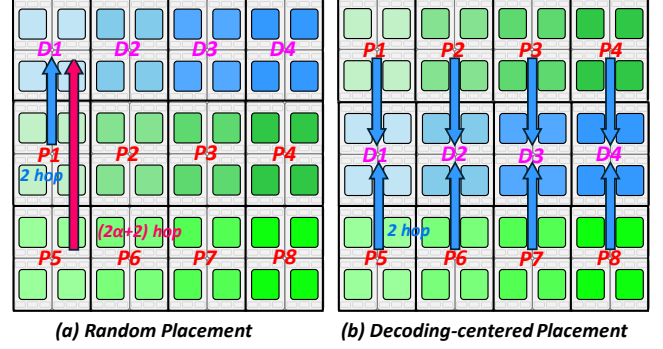


Figure 7: Different resource placement strategies.

prefill technique [10]. This approach divides long prompts into uniformly sized chunks, which are processed iteratively during the prefill phase. By combining batching with chunked prefill technology, we can efficiently handle input prompts of varying lengths across diverse hardware resources.

Taking mapping scheduling in Fig. 8 as an example, the prefill pool contains three queues with 8 dies. QP_1 handles requests 1 and 2, QP_2 manages request 3 and newly arrived request 6, and QP_3 processes requests 4 and 5. The central scheduler has allocated request 6 to the least occupied queue, which is QP_2 . Similarly, requests 7 and 8 are allocated to QP_3 and QP_1 , respectively. Due to the long input tokens of requests 3 and 4, the execution of each request individually can reach the hardware’s computation intensive region. Consequently, the batching strategy is not employed for these requests, thereby avoiding the additional time required to batch with subsequent requests. Specifically, QP_2 will only process request 3 and not request 6, while QP_3 will exclusively execute request 4 without handling request 5.

4.3.2 Decoding Pool. In the decoding pool, each decoding instance maintains a queue QD_i to manage user requests. Each queue QD_i also utilizes the FCFS method to process batched requests. Given the lower computation requirements of the decoding phase, we aim to maximize the efficiency by batching tokens whenever possible. To achieve this, we utilize the continuous batching technique [91], which allows parallel computation of batched tokens for non-attention operations while sequentially computing attention operations.

As shown in Fig. 8, we assume the decoding pool has three queues and each queue is equipped with 4 dies. QD_1 holds requests 1 and 2, QD_2 includes requests 3, and QD_3 contains requests 4 and 5. When generating the next token, requests 1 and 2 are inserted after request 8. These three requests are batched together and executed on DD dies. QD_2 executes requests 6 and 3. Since request 5 only decodes once and terminates, QD_3 runs requests 7 and 4.

4.4 Memory Scheduler

Wafer-scale chips offer high D2D bandwidth, typically exceeding DRAM access bandwidth. Thus, in the absence of D2D link congestion, cross-die DRAM read and write operations are constrained only by DRAM bandwidth rather than D2D bandwidth. Leveraging this advantage of the wafer-scale architecture, the extensive inter-die transfer of KV cache can be overlapped by its DRAM access,

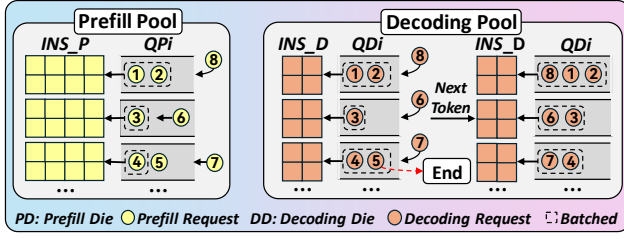


Figure 8: The architecture of the Execution Scheduler.

allowing us to fully utilize all DRAMs on the wafer for KV cache storage to achieve higher performance of LLM service.

As illustrated in Algorithm 2, we implement an optimal KV cache placement algorithm to minimize the additional D2D transmission overhead by allocating the optimal storage location for each request’s KV cache. Given a group requests R , these are executed by prefill instance P_i and decoding instance D_i . The DRAM set is represented by D . The algorithm aims to find the optimal storage location of KV cache for each request.

The algorithm first identifies the associated set of DRAMs D' that require no additional communication, which is determined by the shortest transmission paths of prefill and decoding instances and their respective locations (line 1). For instance, in Fig. 7(b), the associated DRAM set for P_1 and D_1 includes all DRAMs within D_1 , P_1 and P_2 . The algorithm then sorts these DRAMs based on their locations and available capacities, forming a priority queue Q where location priority supersedes residual capacity (line 2).

Subsequently, for each request (line 3), an empty storage set S_i is initialized (line 4), and the total remaining DRAM capacity of Q is verified to ensure it meets the storage requirement of KV cache (line 5). If the total capacity of all remaining DRAMs in Q is insufficient to satisfy the KV cache demands of r_i , the memory scheduler notifies the central scheduler to stop the execution of r_i and subsequent requests on the prefill instance P_i (line 6). Otherwise, the algorithm iteratively allocates DRAM resources to the request r_i (line 8-18). The capacity of each DRAM unit is reduced by the portion utilized during the allocation process. After calculating the remaining capacity, the DRAM unit is reinserted into the queue Q , where it is reordered to maintain the queue’s dynamic prioritization for subsequent allocations. The allocation loop continues until the entire KV cache requirement of r_i is met.

The complexity of Algorithm 2 can be approximately regarded as $O(n)$, where n represents the number of batched requests executed in an instance, typically not exceeding 16. Therefore, the decision-making process of the memory scheduler is highly efficient, ensuring that it does not hinder the execution of WSC-LLM.

4.5 Operator Execution Engine

To efficiently execute LLM operators, computational tasks must be partitioned and mapped across different dies and cores. As illustrated in Fig. 9, taking the GEMM-type operator as an example, it can be partitioned along four dimensions: B , S , H , and K . B represents the batch size, S represents the sequence length, H represents the hidden size, and K represents the other dimension of the weight matrix apart from H . Other operator types, such as Vector (e.g., nonlinear activation functions), feed-forward network (FFN), and Attention mechanism in Transformer architectures [78], can also

Algorithm 2: Optimal KV Cache Placement Algorithm

Input: Batched requests set $R = \{r_1, r_2, \dots, r_n\}$, DRAM set $D = \{d_1, d_2, \dots, d_m\}$, prefill/decoding instance P_i/D_j .

Output: KV cache storage set $\{S_1, S_2, \dots, S_n\}$.

```

1  $D' \leftarrow \text{Relevant}(P_i, D_j)$ 
2  $Q \leftarrow \text{Sort}(D'.\text{location}, D'.\text{capacity})$ 
3 for  $i \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$  do
4    $S_i \leftarrow \emptyset$ 
5   if  $\sum_{d' \in Q} d'.\text{capacity} < r_i.\text{kv}$  then
6     break
7   end
8   else
9     while  $r_i.\text{kv} > 0$  do
10       $d' \leftarrow Q.\text{pop}()$ 
11       $S_i.\text{add}(d')$ 
12      if  $d'.\text{capacity} > r_i.\text{kv}$  then
13         $d'.\text{capacity} \leftarrow r_i.\text{kv}$ 
14         $Q.\text{insert}(d')$ 
15        break
16      end
17      else
18         $r_i.\text{kv} \leftarrow d'.\text{capacity}$ 
19      end
20    end
21  end
22 end
23 return  $\{S_1, S_2, \dots, S_n\}$ 

```

be partitioned across multiple dimensions in a manner similar to the GEMM operator.

The computational task allocation strategy is structured into two levels: (1) Die-level (Section 4.5.1): The TP Engine partitions the overall computational task into sub-computation tasks and maps them across different dies. (2) Core-level (Section 4.5.2): Each sub-task is further partitioned into atom-computation tasks, with each core executing a single atom-computation per time unit.

4.5.1 TP Engine. We classify TP partition strategies according to the number of partition dimensions in sub-computation tasks, categorizing them into two main types: basic TP partition strategy and hybrid TP partition strategy.

Basic TP partition strategy refers to partitioning an operator along a single dimension. Taking the GEMM operator as an example, it involves four dimensions: B , S , H , and K , corresponding to four basic TP partition strategies, respectively. Partitioning along B , S and K requires All-gather communication among different dies within the same instance, and partitioning along H involves All-reduce communication due to the summation operations.

Hybrid TP partition strategies involve operator partition across multiple dimensions. While each additional partition dimension incurs extra All-gather or All-reduce communication overhead, it enables larger TP and instance sizes. Since each instance retains a full copy of the model weights, increasing the instance size reduces the memory footprint of model weights in DRAMs, and provides

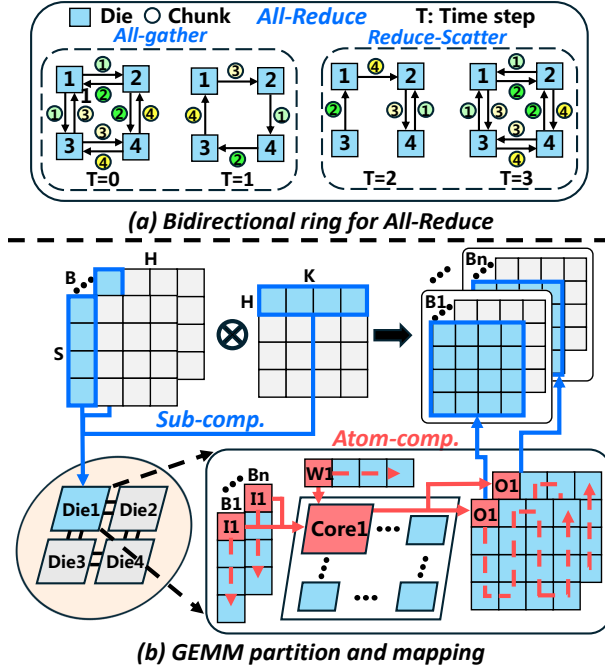


Figure 9: All-reduce communication process and the two-level operator partition and mapping.

the Memory Scheduler with greater optimization space, ultimately leading to potential improved overall system performance.

TP partition strategies for other operator types follow a similar definition as for GEMM. Notably, for the Attention operator, we prioritize partition it along the Q, K, and V heads, which form the basic TP partition strategy. LLaMA3-70B employs the Grouped Query Attention (GQA) mechanism, featuring only eight KV heads. As shown in Fig. 5, when TP size is 16, a hybrid TP partition strategy is required. In this case, each K and V head is further partitioned along an additional dimension, such as H , ensuring that each die retains only half of the K and V head.

We implement the All-gather and All-reduce communications in the TP process using the bidirectional Ring algorithm [82], which is well-suited for the 2D-mesh communication network of wafer-scale chips. Fig. 9(a) illustrates the All-reduce communication process when TP size is 4, requiring a total of four time steps. All-reduce can be decomposed into two phases: Reduce-Scatter and All-gather, with each phase comprising two time steps.

4.5.2 Intra-Die Engine. Upon receiving the sub-computation task assigned by the TP Engine, each die further partitions it along multiple dimensions, such as B , S , H , and K , to generate atom-computation tasks. Each atom-computation task must comply with the SRAM constraints of the computing core and is mapped to a single computing core for execution within one time step.

Fig. 9(b) illustrates the complete two-level task allocation process. First, the TP Engine partitions the operator along the H dimension and maps the sub-computation task to Die1. Then, further partitioning along the S and K dimensions is performed, mapping each atom-computation task based on the Weight Stationary (WS) approach, iteratively completing the computation.

It is important to note that the WS mapping strategy shown in Fig. 9(b) may not always be the most efficient, as it might overlook opportunities to reuse SRAM within computing cores to reduce system overhead. Therefore, we further explore optimal intra-die mapping strategies to achieve the best execution performance. To exploring the mapping space of atom-computation tasks efficiently, we employ heuristic algorithms [24, 79, 99] to make full use of the intra-layer pipelining [23, 27, 35, 42–44, 52, 80, 86].

4.6 Evaluator

The evaluator in the WSC-LLM framework is built upon ASTRA-sim [83], an open-source distributed training simulator developed using real hardware measurements. Our intra-die engine (Section 4.5.2) serves as the interface for global performance evaluation, analyzing the execution time of computation tasks within a single die. Based on the prior work, we introduce two significant efforts.

First, we extend ASTRA-sim to support the inference process of LLMs, which is inherently dynamic across iterations, unlike the relatively static nature of the training process. This extension enables independent simulation of each iteration in the LLM inference process and aggregates the statistical results across all iterations at the end, thereby achieving iteration-level hardware simulation.

Secondly, to meet the real-time requirements of LLM inference, we pre-build and store the mapping lookup table offline. First, we explore the optimal intra-die mapping strategy for representative configurations in test datasets, including different models, phases, token counts, and batch sizes. For each configuration, key results such as latency, DRAM access volume, and communication overhead are recorded. Subsequently, these results are used to train a DNN to model the relationship between input metrics and outcomes. Finally, the DNN is employed to estimate results across all possible configurations within the test dataset to complete the construction of the mapping lookup table. During the online execution of WSC-LLM, the lookup table remains static, requiring only read operations with negligible overhead. Existing simulator works [37, 89] validate the feasibility of this approach, demonstrating that the error of the fitted results is within a controllable range.

5 Evaluation

5.1 Experiment Setup

5.1.1 Basic Hardware Configurations. To facilitate the exploration of wafer-scale chip architecture, we configured the parameters of the compute die according to the setup described in Fig. 3. The compute die measures $21.92 \text{ mm} \times 22.81 \text{ mm}$ and consists of a 16×16 array of Dojo-style[73] compute cores. It is manufactured using TSMC’s 7 nm process technology and operates at a frequency of 1 GHz. The interconnect interface of the compute die provides a total interconnect bandwidth of 6 TB/s across four directions. Such high interconnect bandwidth enables overlapping communication with memory access during the decoding phase or computation during the prefill phase. Each core delivers a computational power of 1.02 TFLOPS (Tensor FP16) and features 1.25 MB of SRAM.

5.1.2 Architectural Design Space Exploration. In this study, we conduct an architectural design space exploration of wafer-scale chips with the compute die described in Section 5.1.1. A single die can

Table 1: Configuration Parameters

Config. Type	Case 1	Case 2	Case 3	Case 4
#Die in X-dim	7	7	6	6
#Die in Y-dim	9	8	9	8
DRAM Bandwidth	1TB/s	1.5TB/s	2TB/s	3TB/s
DRAM Capacity	32GB	48GB	64GB	96GB
D2D Bandwidth	2.5TB/s	2.25TB/s	2TB/s	1.5TB/s

integrate varying numbers of DRAM chiplets, offering different memory capacities and bandwidth. This exploration aims to demonstrate the advantages of WSC-LLM and gain a deeper understanding of the trade-offs among computation, memory, and communication resources within wafer-scale chips. Table 1 outlines four feasible wafer-scale chip configurations within a 12-inch wafer area, which serve as the basis for our design space exploration (DSE).

5.1.3 Workloads. We choose a series of models from 7B to 175B for our experiments, including LLaMA2-7B [77], LLaMA-30B [76], LLaMA3-70B [20], and GPT-175B [13]. LLaMA, LLaMA2, LLaMA3, and GPT are the most representative and widely used decoder-only LLM model, with a similar structure to other models like Mistral [38], Falcon [11], OPT [96], BLOOM [67] and so on. LLaMA3-70B utilize group query attention (GQA), which partitions queries into groups and each group shares attention scores and a key-value (KV) matrix. In contrast, other models employ multi-head attention (MHA), in which each query maintains an independent KV matrix. We use FP16 precision for all workloads.

5.1.4 Datasets. We employ the actual production traces [1] from a cloud provider, Azure. The traces include the arrival time, input prompt size, and output token number for requests in one-hour serving. We use traces of code and conversation representing the most common scenarios in LLM inference. For the conversation (conv) dataset, the median number of prompt tokens is 1020 tokens and the average number is 1155, while the median number of decoding tokens is 129 tokens and the average number is 212. For the code dataset, the median number of prompt tokens is 1500, and the average is 2048, while the median number of decoding tokens is 13 and the average number is 28. Moreover, we increase and decrease the request load per second by adjusting the Poisson arrival rate for various model and cluster sizes.

5.1.5 Metrics. To comprehensively measure the overall performance of our system, we choose End-to-end (E2E) latency and Transaction Per Second (TPS). E2E latency represents the total response time for a user request and it includes prefill execution, decoding execution, and request waiting time. As decoding dominates LLM workloads, computation and unoverlapped communication should constitute a very low portion (<5%) of the total execution time in an efficient LLM service system. TPS represents the number of user requests processed per second.

5.2 Architectural Design Space Exploration

Fig. 10 illustrates the overall performance results of four feasible wafer-scale architectures across four LLM models and two datasets. These experiments cover variations in model architecture, input sequence length, and batch size, providing a comprehensive

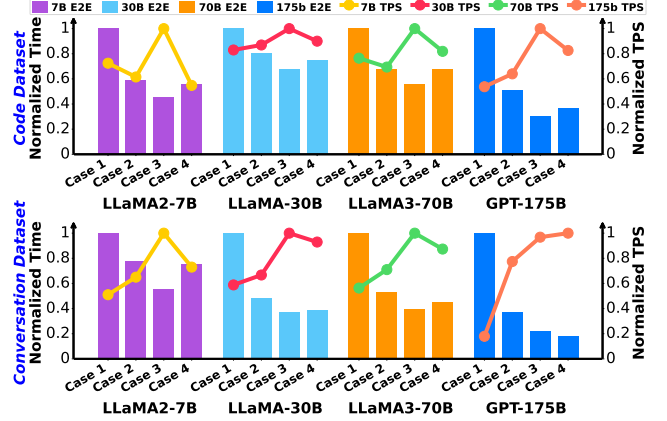


Figure 10: Overall comparisons of E2E latency and TPS among case 1, 2, 3, and 4.

and general evaluation. The wafer-scale chip with 54 dies (case 3) consistently achieves optimal performance in nearly all scenarios, demonstrating its ability to effectively adapt to variations in model architectures and workloads. This establishes case 3 as the best wafer-scale chip architecture. **The above result demonstrates that wafer-scale chips with moderate DRAM capacity per die can effectively balance computation, storage, and communication resources, delivering superior quality of service for LLM workloads.** Conversely, architectures with either excessively large or small DRAM capacity per die tend to suffer from a negative impact due to the deficiency of one or two hardware resources, leading to degraded performance.

A comparison of cases 1, 2, and 3 reveals that the overall performance of cases 1 and 2 is significantly inferior to that of case 3, particularly when evaluated on the conv dataset. This disparity can be attributed to the higher proportion of decoding phases in the conv dataset, where performance is heavily constrained by memory bandwidth and capacity. Specifically, during the decoding phase, neither enhanced computation power nor increased D2D bandwidth can compensate for insufficient DRAM bandwidth and capacity. *This finding underscores DRAM bandwidth and capacity as key factors in determining the quality of LLM service.*

When comparing case 3 and case 4, we find that although case 4 has higher DRAM bandwidth than case 3, its overall performance is inferior. This performance discrepancy arises due to its lower D2D bandwidth. During inter-die data access, the limited D2D bandwidth becomes the new bottleneck, replacing DRAM bandwidth as the primary constraint. This observation highlights a critical **insight: achieving efficient LLM service requires not only high DRAM bandwidth but also sufficient communication bandwidth. A balance between memory and communication resources is essential for optimal performance.** This principle applies not only to wafer-scale chips but also to other hardware platforms, emphasizing the importance of balanced resource allocation in achieving high-quality LLM services.

5.3 Overall Performance

We select the optimal wafer-scale chip configuration (case 3) for comparison with Splitwise [62], the SOTA LLM service system

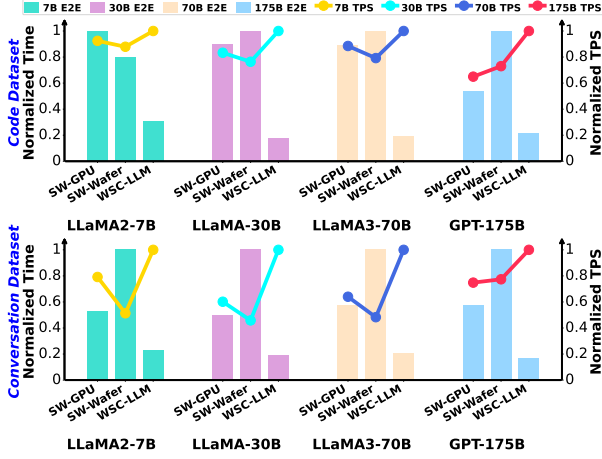


Figure 11: Overall comparisons of E2E latency and TPS between Splitwise-GPU, Splitwise-Wafer and WSC-LLM.

based on GPU clusters, denoted as **SW-GPU**. To ensure a fair comparison, we use a configuration for Splitwise comprising six 8-A100-80GB GPU nodes, with inter-node bandwidth of 400 GB/s. In terms of computation resources, the total compute capability of Splitwise is 14,976 TFLOPS (Tensor FP16), which exceeds the 14,100 TFLOPS provided by the wafer-scale chip. For memory resources, Splitwise has a total DRAM capacity of 3,840 GB, also surpassing the 3,456 GB of DRAM available on the wafer-scale chip. Both systems feature a DRAM bandwidth of 2 TB/s. Additionally, we directly apply Splitwise’s scheduling strategy to our wafer-scale chip (case 3) as a control experiment, denoted as **SW-Wafer**.

Fig. 11 illustrates the normalized E2E latency and TPS results on code and conversation datasets. WSC-LLM achieves an **average 3.12× improvement** in E2E latency and a 36.47% increase in TPS compared to SW-GPU, and an average 4.81× improvement in E2E latency and a 57.17% increase in TPS compared to SW-Wafer, across four LLM models and two datasets. Despite having fewer computation and memory resources, WSC-LLM demonstrates superior performance due to its highly efficient operator execution and scheduling strategies, which are specifically tailored to leverage the unique advantages of wafer-scale architecture. The performance gap between SW-GPU and SW-Wafer can be attributed both to less hardware resources (with SW-GPU having approximately 6% less compute and 11% less memory resource) and to the fact that the Splitwise strategy is designed primarily for GPU architectures, lacking the optimizations necessary for wafer-scale chips. **These results indicate that using WSC-LLM on wafer-scale chips shows exceptional promise for LLM services.**

5.4 Ablation Studies

To evaluate the impact of different WSC-LLM’s optimization strategies, we conduct experiments on a 54-die wafer-scale chip (case 3). As shown in Fig. 12, WSC-LLM is compared with two baselines, each disabling one optimization strategy. **no-Central** removes TP size search and resource allocation and placement strategy in Central Scheduler, fixing TP size at six dies for prefill and decoding instances (18 dies for GPT3-175B) and using a random placement strategy. **no-Memory** disables Memory Scheduler, requiring the

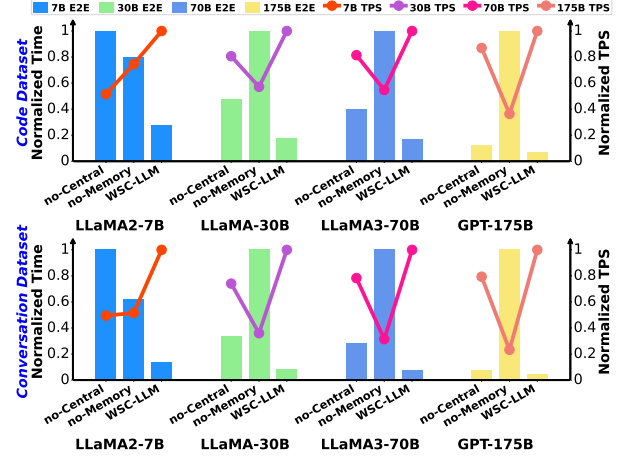


Figure 12: Overall comparisons of E2E latency and TPS among no-Central, no-Memory, and WSC-LLM.

generated KV cache from prefill instances to be fully transferred to decoding instances for storage.

We can observe the following phenomena: (1) Phenomenon 1: As model size increases, performance gains from the Central Scheduler gradually diminish; (2) Phenomenon 2: Conversely, benefits of the Memory Scheduler grow with the model size.

The explanation for Phenomenon 1 lies in the fact that smaller LLMs typically have smaller optimal instance size and a larger number of instances, making them deviate more from a fixed instance size and more affected by resource allocation and placement strategies. For Phenomenon 2, larger LLMs generally require more memory resource due to their increased weight parameters and KV cache. Although LLaMA3-70B reduces KV cache through GQA mechanism, its weight size is still 2.33× that of LLaMA-30B. Due to the absence of the Memory Scheduler, no-Memory fails to fully utilize DRAM resources, resulting in increased memory pressure when handling larger LLMs with higher memory demands, leading to degraded performance. **These results confirm that by leveraging the Central Scheduler and Memory Scheduler, WSC-LLM can support high-performance LLM services across various models and workloads.**

In addition, we observe that for LLaMA-30B, LLaMA3-70B, and GPT-175B, the Memory Scheduler plays a more significant role in performance improvement whereas the Central Scheduler has a greater impact only on LLaMA2-7B. Combined with the result in Fig. 11, which show WSC-LLM achieves greater performance gains over Splitwise as model size grows, we conclude that: **The Memory Scheduler in WSC-LLM plays a more critical role than the Central Scheduler in enhancing LLM service quality.**

5.5 Learn from a Complete LLM Service Process

In this section, we demonstrate the advantages of WSC-LLM according to a complete real-world LLM inference process (Fig. 13) and analyze the principles of its performance improvements. **Splitwise-Wafer** serves as the baseline, representing the direct application of Splitwise’s scheduling strategy to wafer-scale chips.

Fig. 13(a) presents the die utilization heatmap for LLaMA3-70B on the conversation dataset. It is evident that WSC-LLM achieves

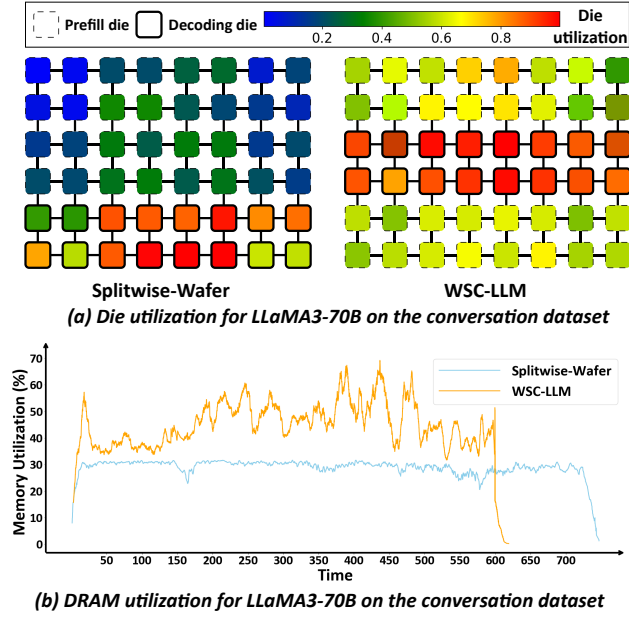


Figure 13: Overall comparisons of die utilization and DRAM utilization for LLaMA3-70B on the conversation dataset.

significantly higher overall die utilization compared to Splitwise-Wafer, as indicated by the absence of blue or dark green dies. The performance improvement primarily stems from the designs of our Central Scheduler and Memory Scheduler:

(1) Splitwise-Wafer suffers from inefficient resource partition and placement strategies, leading to a higher total number of communication hops for edge dies. This results in frequent communication congestion, forcing computations to stall until data transmission is completed. This also explains why prefill and decoding dies in Splitwise-Wafer exhibit higher utilization in central dies while remaining underutilized at the edges. In contrast, WSC-LLM, benefiting from our Central Scheduler, achieves a more balanced utilization pattern and improved overall performance.

(2) Our Memory Scheduler can effectively leverage the idle memory resources in Splitwise-Wafer. As shown in Fig. 13(b), WSC-LLM achieves significantly higher DRAM utilization compared to Splitwise-Wafer. More DRAM space allows for storing additional KV cache of user requests, enhancing the ability to execute decoding requests in parallel and reducing the frequency of prefill dies being stalled due to insufficient DRAM space.

Furthermore, both Splitwise-Wafer and WSC-LLM exhibit higher utilization in decoding dies, highlighting the dominant role of the decoding phase. Notably, simply allocating more dies for decoding phase while reducing prefill dies does not improve LLM service quality. This is because the decoding phase is constrained by DRAM access bandwidth, and increasing dies cannot resolve it. On the contrary, it may degrade the performance of the prefill phase.

6 Discussion

6.1 Architectural Generality

As mentioned in Section 2.3, WSC-LLM is equipped with various configurable architectural parameters. For wafer-scale chips with

varying parameter configurations, WSC-LLM can automatically perform end-to-end scheduling to achieve optimal LLM inference results. Notably, WSC-LLM is capable of optimizing not only for scenarios with high D2D bandwidth but also for cases with lower D2D bandwidth, as demonstrated in Section 5.1 with case 4. Moreover, the results in Section 5.3 demonstrate that WSC-LLM achieves significant performance improvements on various models including LLaMA and GPT and different model sizes from 7B to 175B. **In summary, WSC-LLM demonstrates excellent generality, adapting well to different LLM models and sizes and different architectural parameters of wafer-scale chips.**

6.2 Scalability

While wafer-scale chips offer higher integration density, their limited area constrains the computation and storage resources compared to GPU clusters with dozens or even hundreds of nodes. For LLM inference scenarios with large parameter sizes and high user request rates, utilizing multi-wafer-scale chip systems becomes imperative.

We select a wafer-scale chip array composed of 2×2 case 3 and compare its performance to Splitwise[62], which consists of twenty-four 8-A100-80GB GPU nodes, to demonstrate the scalability of WSC-LLM. For wafer-to-wafer (W2W) interconnect bandwidth, we considered two configurations: the state-of-the-art 1.8 TB/s W2W interconnect[73], denoted as WSC-LLM-18, and a configuration with 400 GB/s W2W bandwidth, matching the interconnect bandwidth of Splitwise inter-node, denoted as WSC-LLM-4. In addition, we test the LLaMA3-405B to demonstrate WSC-LLM's effective support for ultra-large models.

As shown in Fig. 14, we can observe two key phenomena. (1) Phenomenon 1: WSC-LLM consistently outperforms Splitwise in both high and low W2W bandwidth scenarios. (2) Phenomenon 2: WSC-LLM can achieve greater performance improvement on the ultra-large model LLaMA3-405B.

For Phenomenon 1, the superior performance of WSC-LLM stems from its ability to fully utilize the computational and memory resources of a single wafer to efficiently execute LLM inference. Additionally, multiple wafers can independently handle different requests in parallel, effectively minimizing the need for extensive W2W communication. In scenarios with higher W2W bandwidth, WSC-LLM can further optimize performance by employing more aggressive cross-wafer memory scheduling strategies.

For Phenomenon 2, this can be attributed to the substantial memory demands of LLaMA3-405B, which has 910GB model weights, requiring at least two GPU nodes to store a single weight replica. As a result, Splitwise incurs significant inter-node communication overhead when executing intra-instance computations, leading to performance degradation. In contrast, the memory capacity of a single wafer-scale chip (case 3) is sufficient to accommodate a complete model replica. Consequently, even WSC-LLM-4 can achieve substantial performance improvements.

7 Related Work

LLM Serving and Disaggregated Inference. In real-time online LLM service systems [10, 45, 84, 91, 100], continuous batching is a

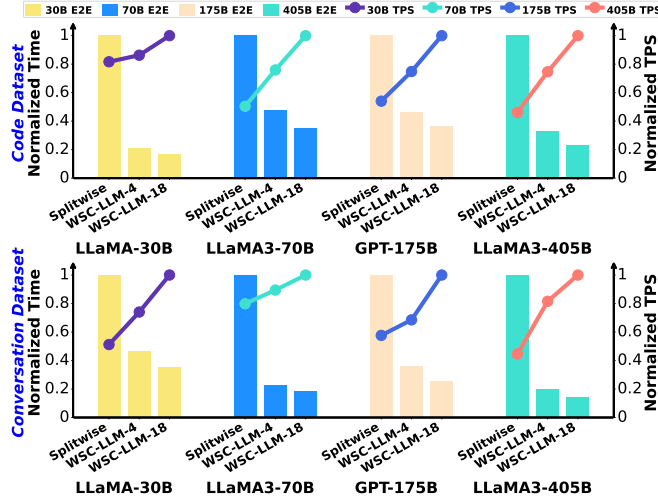


Figure 14: Overall comparisons of E2E latency and TPS among Splitwise, WSC-LLM-4, and WSC-LLM-18.

widely adopted technique that processes both the prefill and decoding phases of multiple requests within each iteration. This method aims to enhance the overall system throughput by minimizing idle hardware resources. However, since the prefill and decoding phases are constrained by computing power and memory bandwidth, respectively, continuous batching causes prefill-decoding interference. This interference leads to a trade-off within the LLM service system between optimizing the prefill and decoding phase, making it challenging to achieve simultaneous performance optimization for both phases.

Some existing LLM service systems [31, 62, 72, 100] have recognized the differences between the prefill and decoding phases and have executed them on separate devices, known as disaggregated inference. However, these efforts lack a fine-grained exploration of optimal resource allocation and do not focus on wafer-scale chips. As a result, they fail to fully leverage the flexible scheduling and high-bandwidth characteristics of wafer-scale chips, missing the opportunity to improve compute and memory utilization and to reduce additional KV cache transfer overhead.

Wafer-scale chips and Chiplet accelerators. For wafer-scale chips, existing research primarily focuses on architectural exploration [16, 22, 60, 65, 101] and layout design [39, 51, 53, 59]. However, these studies lack an understanding of the imbalances between prefill and decoding phases, and the memory management.

Regarding chiplet accelerators, research has addressed design space exploration (DSE) [15, 40, 58, 94, 98], data flow scheduling [24, 57], and SRAM optimization [25, 69]. Nevertheless, these efforts have mainly concentrated on optimizing traditional DNNs, such as CNNs, and SRAM, whereas our focus is on optimizing LLMs and DRAM utilization. Furthermore, all research overlooks the critical issue of balancing memory, computation, and communication resources within wafer-scale chip architectures.

8 Conclusion

In this work, we introduce WSC-LLM, an efficient LLM service and architecture co-exploration framework for wafer-scale chips. To the

best of our knowledge, this is the first work to achieve it. Leveraging the high bandwidth and topology characteristics of wafer-scale chips, WSC-LLM introduces optimal hardware resource allocation and placement strategies, as well as KV cache memory management policies, unearthing hidden optimization opportunities. Regarding architecture, we provide a highly configurable hardware template and an accurate performance evaluator built upon existing well-established frameworks. Our experiments demonstrate that the architectures and scheduling strategies explored by WSC-LLM on wafer-scale chips significantly outperform both the SOTA LLM service system based on GPU clusters and the direct application of its scheduling strategy to wafer-scale chips. Furthermore, we provide profound insights into the design of wafer-scale architectures and the execution of LLM workloads.

Acknowledgments

This work was supported in part by the National Science and Technology Major Project under Grant 2022ZD0115200; in part by the NSFC under Grant 62125403, Grant 92464302, Grant U24B20164 and Grant 92164301; in part by Shanghai Municipal Science and Technology Major Project; in part by the Natural Science Foundation of Jiangsu Province Basic Research Program under Grant BK20243042; in part by the Beijing National Research Center for Information Science and Technology; in part by the Northern IC Technology Innovation Center (Beijing) Co., Ltd under Grant QYJS20232801B; and in part by the Beijing Advanced Innovation Center for Integrated Circuits.

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